



STEVEN BIKO (1946–77)

In 1968, Steve Biko was the first president and cofounder of the all-black South African Students' Organization (SASO), which aimed to raise black consciousness. The government banned him in 1973, but he continued to spread his word. On August 18, 1977, the police seized Biko, held him for 24 days, and tortured him to death. The *Rand Daily Mail* exposed their brutality.

Amnesty International, the human rights organization, won the **Nobel Peace Prize** for having "contributed to securing the ground for freedom, for justice, and thereby also for peace in the world." The movement proclaimed 1977 "**Prisoners of Conscience Year**." The following year, Amnesty also received the United Nations Human Rights Award.



Dr. Robert Edwards holds the world's first test tube baby, Louise Brown. It was a medical breakthrough fraught with controversy.

“ **ALL EXAMINATIONS SHOWED THAT THE BABY IS QUITE NORMAL.** ”

Obstetrician Patrick Steptoe, after the birth of Louise Brown

ISRAELI SOLDIERS CROSSED THE LEBANESE BORDER on March 14, in Operation Litani. Thousands of **Palestinians** fled the area and hundreds died. Israel claimed Palestinian fighters were using southern Lebanon to mount attacks against civilian and military targets in Israel.

Demonstrators on the streets of **Tehran**, capital of Iran, had been shouting dissent all year, but in September, **protests grew** against the policies of Iran's supreme ruler, **Shah Mohammed Reza Pahlavi** (1919–80). The challenge stunned the Shah and his generals, and rioters were attacked. Many people were killed, and **martial law** was imposed in major cities.

Egyptian President **Anwar Sadat** (1918–81) arrived in Washington, DC for talks with **President Jimmy Carter** (b. 1924), in February. His visit represented a change in **Egyptian foreign policy** which had previously sought favor from the **Soviet Union**. Shortly after, Israeli Prime Minister **Menachem Begin** met President Carter. These initial talks paved the way for historic joint meetings at Camp David, Maryland, in September 5–17. Here, both sides signed the **Camp David Peace Accord** for peace in the Middle East. Sadat and Begin later received the Nobel Peace Prize.

Cambodia was **invaded by Vietnam** on December 25 in a lightning assault. The Vietnamese forced out **Pol Pot's Khmer Rouge** regime, but the war that followed continued to be a major source of international tension.

Pol Pot's army was not completely defeated; thousands of his troops fled to the **Thai–Cambodia border**, where they were able to build up their strength, and skirmishes forced the Vietnamese to stay in Cambodia for the next decade (see 1991).

Former Italian prime minister **Aldo Moro** was **kidnapped** in Rome on March 16. The extreme left-wing **Red Brigade**, who wished to overthrow capitalist Italy, claimed responsibility and demanded that the trial of their leader, Renato Curcio, be stopped. The government refused, and eight weeks later, **Moro's body** was found in the trunk of a car in Rome.

The oil tanker **Amoco Cadiz** ran aground on Portsall Rocks, three miles off the Brittany coast, when its steering mechanism failed. The entire cargo of 1.6 million barrels spilled into the sea, causing an **oil slick** 18 miles (30km) wide and 80 miles (130km) long. Dozens of Breton **beaches were polluted**. Devastating scenes of marine animals covered in oil and dying were broadcast around the world.

The world's **first test tube baby** was born on July 25. **Louise Brown** was born in Oldham, Lancashire, England, with the help of gynecologist **Patrick Steptoe**, who had pioneered the technique along with **Dr. Robert Edwards** (see 1969).

Khmer Rouge fighter
Under Pol Pot, Khmer Rouge soldiers, often teenagers, controlled Cambodia. They were responsible for killing over 1 million people.



November 18 President Sadat of Egypt is first Arab leader to visit Israel

September 12 Death of anti-apartheid activist Steven Biko (b. 1946)

December 25 Death of Charlie Chaplin, actor and director (b. 1889)

March 14 Israel invades Lebanon

March 16 Oil tanker Amoco Cadiz founders off coast of Brittany

June Space Invaders, an arcade video game, is launched in the US

April 30 Afghan president, Mohammed Daoud, is killed in military coup

June 25 Argentina wins soccer World Cup

July 25 Birth of first test tube baby, Louise Brown

August 25 Turin Shroud goes on display in Turin for first time in 45 years

August 22 Death of Jomo Kenyatta, president of Kenya

August 26 Albino Cardinal Luciani elected Pope and becomes Pope John I

September 8 Shah of Iran imposes martial law

September 30 Death of Pope John I after 33 days in office

September 5–17 President Carter hosts Camp David peace talks

October 16 Cardinal Karol Wojtyla of Poland elected pope; becomes Pope John Paul II

November 3 Dominica gains independence from Britain

November 29 Mass suicide in Guyana by members of American religious cult, the People's Temple

December 8 Death of Golda Meir (b. 1898), first woman prime minister of Israel

December 25 Vietnam invades Cambodia

December 27 Death of Houari Boumedienne, president of Algeria (b. 1932)